



Curriculum and Assessment Policy

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Introduction

This policy outlines the principles, structure, and expectations for delivering a broad, balanced, and ambitious curriculum across our independent special school. It ensures full compliance with the Education (Independent School Standards) Regulations 2014 (as amended 2019) and aligns with the National Curriculum in England, while being tailored to meet the needs of pupils with autism.

Our curriculum is designed to:

- ensure every pupil has access to the knowledge, skills, and cultural capital needed to thrive in modern Britain
- place emotional development, wellbeing, and resilience at the heart of learning
- support academic progress while nurturing personal growth and independence
- provide flexibility and differentiation to meet the wide-ranging needs of our learners, all of whom have an EHCP and additional vulnerabilities

This policy also reflects the expectations of the non-association independent school inspection toolkit that sets out the areas that will be evaluated and graded on standard inspections of non-association independent schools inspected by Ofsted under sections 108 and 109 of the Education and Skills Act 2008. This policy evidences our commitment to meeting the educational needs of all our pupils with Special Educational Needs and Disabilities (SEND).

We recognise that many of our pupils arrive having faced significant barriers to learning, including disrupted education due to:

- Having been out of school for some time
- Having EBSA (Emotional Based School Avoidance)
- Having very high anxiety
- Having a PDA profile (Pathological Demand Avoidance - a cluster of recognisable traits that include social communication and interaction difficulties and 'obsessive' interests), with consequent difficulties engaging in learning and social activity

As a result, our pupils often present with gaps in learning and are working below age-related expectations. Our curriculum is therefore designed to be responsive, relational, and aspirational, ensuring that every pupil is supported to make meaningful progress from their individual starting point. At our school, the curriculum encompasses every planned learning experience, both formal and informal, throughout the school day. This includes lessons, enrichment activities, therapeutic interventions, and social learning opportunities. All staff, supported by Subject Leads, the Head of Learning and the Head of SEND are responsible for planning and structuring these experiences to maximise their impact on attainment, progress, and personal development.

We set aspirational end points for each pupil, informed by their baseline assessments, EHCP outcomes, and individual needs. Each subject is planned with explicit, sequential building blocks of knowledge, ensuring that pupils can build towards meaningful awards, qualifications, independence, and successful transitions into adulthood.

Curriculum Intent

We ensure structured and meaningful learning across the following domains:

- Linguistic – English, communication, literacy, and where appropriate, modern foreign languages
- Mathematical – Mathematics, numeracy, and problem-solving
- Scientific – Science and technology
- Technological – Computing and/or design and technology
- Human and Social – History, geography, religious education and/or social studies
- Physical – Physical education, movement, health, and fitness
- Aesthetic and Creative – Art, music, drama, and/or design

In addition, our curriculum:

- Delivers core knowledge and skills aligned with the National Curriculum, with appropriate adaptation for pupils with SEND.
- Provides Personal, Social, Health and Economic Education (PSHE), including Relationships and Sex Education (RSE) where statutory.
- Promotes Spiritual, Moral, Social and Cultural (SMSC) development and British Values—democracy, rule of law, individual liberty, mutual respect, and tolerance.
- Embeds a strong focus on independence, life skills, and personal development, placing emotional wellbeing at the centre.
- Prepares pupils for further education, training, employment, and confident participation in adult and community life.

Where appropriate, and with the approval of the Proprietor, the school may adopt and adapt nationally recognised curriculum designs and frameworks to support consistency, quality, and statutory alignment. Examples include the use of PSHE Association for PSHE and RSHE, and other accredited schemes that support progression, adaptation, and inspection readiness. These resources are selected to ensure accessibility for our pupils with SEND to support staff in delivering sequenced, ambitious learning across settings.

Curriculum Implementation

Our curriculum is delivered through:

- small class sizes, or in some cases on a 1:1 basis, with appropriately qualified and trained staff
- balanced weekly timetables that ensure depth in core subjects while allowing time for enrichment and therapeutic input
- individualised pathways based on EHCP outcomes, baseline assessments, and ongoing review.

- access to accreditation at appropriate levels, including Functional Skills, ASDAN programmes and qualifications, AQA awards
- a consistent emphasis on inclusion, safeguarding, and wellbeing across all subjects and settings

Our approach is strongly influenced by the thinking and research behind Relationship Development Intervention (RDI®): to mirror the developmental steps that children have missed during infancy. By doing so, they have a second chance to develop their ability to:

- share Experience
- take different perspectives and think flexibly
- collaborate
- cope with Setbacks and challenges
- solve Problems creatively

Measuring Curriculum Impact

We evaluate the effectiveness of our curriculum through:

- academic progress tracked against personalised and nationally recognised benchmarks, reviewed by school and organisational leadership, including governors
- social, emotional, and behavioural development, using validated tools and frameworks
- achievement of external qualifications, evidencing readiness for next steps
- preparation for adulthood, including employment, further study, and independent living, tracked against EHCP targets and aspirations
- attendance, engagement, and participation data, analysed to inform interventions and support
- feedback from pupils, parents, carers, and professionals, ensuring the curriculum remains responsive and relevant
- external quality assurance, including Ofsted inspections, local authority reviews, and hub network

Ultimate Measure of Success

Pupils leave our schools with:

- improved life chances through successful progression to the next stage of their education and/or chosen vocation
- greater self-confidence, independence, and resilience
- the skills, knowledge, and qualifications to progress successfully into adulthood
- improved self-regulation (managing own emotions and behaviour)
- improvement in coping with uncertainty and change (decreasing anxiety)
- increased ability to make and sustain meaningful reciprocal relationships

- increased independence
- improved quality of life with reduced stress for pupils and their families

Roles and Responsibilities

Delivering a high-quality curriculum is a collective responsibility. Every member of staff plays a role in ensuring that pupils access learning that is ambitious, broad, balanced, and responsive to their needs. Responsibilities are defined at each level of leadership and practice:

The Head of Learning and the Head of SEND will provide strategic direction for curriculum design, ensuring breadth, balance and relevance for children with autism.

The Head of Learning will:

- lead on curriculum vision, ensuring alignment with the school's ethos
- ensure that the timetable provides statutory coverage, as well as appropriate time spent on subjects and therapeutic provision which reflects the needs of the cohort
- oversee and quality-assure teaching and learning and curriculum planning and delivery through regular learning walks
- ensure assessment systems used to analyse individual, group, or whole-school data to identify trends and needs to inform curriculum direction
- ensure that the curriculum contributes to pupils' SMSC development, British Values, and equality objectives
- deploy resources (staffing, environment) to enable effective curriculum delivery
- ensure staff receive induction, training, and supervision to deliver the curriculum effectively
- ensure that the curriculum policy aligns with the Independent School Standards and wider statutory requirements

The Head of SEND will:

- ensure the curriculum matches the needs of all our pupils and contributes to their specific EHC outcomes
- provide specialised knowledge of the steps that can be taken to support all our pupils
- aim to ensure that all our pupils are given the appropriate accommodations, resources, and interventions to help them achieve their full potential
- quality-assure how teaching and learning is adapted for pupils with autism and additional SEND through regular learning walks
- liaise with external agencies where applicable, i.e. specialist advisors, clinical team, to ensure subject content is accessible, engaging, and relevant to pupils' needs and aspirations

Curriculum Leads are responsible for the quality and consistency of curriculum provision in their areas. They will:

- review the planning of the curriculum content with the Head of Learning, ensuring it is well sequenced to promote pupil progress
- ensure the planned curriculum is implemented across the school and inform the Head of Learning of updates and changes.
- make sure there is effective use of iASEND and oversee the progress of pupils
- deliver necessary training to the whole staff team and individuals with support from the Head of Learning.
- provide support to staff regarding teaching and learning, resources, and planning in the subject area
- facilitate Book Looks and Pupil Interviews and provide feedback to the Head of Learning
- support Learning Mentors to make accurate assessments.
- provide support with online resources, textbooks and library books in the subject area
- audit, check and manage resources to ensure they are up to date and match pupil and curriculum needs
- ensure that subject delivery contributes to pupils' SMSC development, British Values, and equality objectives

Teaching Staff (Learning Mentors) are central to curriculum delivery. They will:

- plan and deliver lessons that are ambitious, engaging, and tailored to pupils' learning needs
- use adaptive pedagogy to ensure pupils feel safe, valued, and motivated
- set clear learning objectives linked to EHCP outcomes, National Curriculum content and wider development
- adapt resources and approaches to ensure accessibility for all pupils
- record pupil progress in both academic and personal development areas using iASEND to ensure effective oversight
- foster positive relationships and role-model respectful behaviour, embedding British Values and SMSC through everyday practice
- act as trusted adults, ensuring pupils feel safe, understood, and supported in accessing the curriculum
- promote careers education through the subject and how the subject might lead to post-16 opportunities

Learning mentors should have:

- Secure knowledge of skills, concepts and technical vocabulary.
- An understanding of every child's prior learning.
- Clear description and presentation of the learning intention.

- Success criteria so that they support each child's learning throughout the lesson and to promote independent learning

Lessons/ Sessions should have:

- Opportunities for children to think about and discuss the skills and concepts throughout the lesson.
- Multisensory strategies to engage pupils and focus on the students next steps on their learning journey.
- Feedback throughout the lesson to find out and demonstrate how the learning is progressing.
- Use of strategies to help to assess the learning acquired during the lesson so that the next lesson can be planned to take account of prior learning.
- Appropriate support and challenge for pupils
- Good questioning

Lessons/ Sessions should be:

- Organised - Planning based on the students ability and next learning steps
- Interactive – pupils' contributions are encouraged and extended.
- Supportive – a friendly, supportive environment to encourage learning.
- Well-paced – appropriate to the pupil's ability and engagement.
- Ambitious – there is optimism about and high expectations of success.
- Confident – Learning Mentors have a clear understanding of the objectives.

The Proprietor is responsible for the quality and impact of the curriculum. They will:

- ensure that the curriculum complies with the Independent School Standards, the non-association independent school inspection toolkit and other regulatory statutory requirements.
- monitor the implementation and impact of the curriculum
- provide challenge and support to school leaders to ensure continuous improvement
- review progress against strategic objectives, including pupil outcomes, curriculum breadth, and equality of opportunity
- ensure that the curriculum reflects the ethos of the organisation and serves the best interests of pupils.

Equality and inclusion

We are committed to ensuring that all pupils, regardless of background, need or ability, have equal access to a broad, balanced and ambitious curriculum. Our approach to inclusion and equality is underpinned by the principles of the Independent School Standards, the Equality Act 2010, and the SEND Code of Practice (2015).

Our curriculum ensures that:

- Access for all: Every pupil is entitled to a curriculum that meets their individual needs, abilities, and aspirations, including those with Education, Health and Care Plans (EHCPs).
- Differentiation and adaptation: Learning Mentors adapt planning, resources, and teaching strategies to enable access for pupils with a wide range of SEMH, cognitive, sensory, or physical needs.
- High expectations: We maintain ambitious expectations for all pupils, regardless of background or prior attainment, ensuring they can make progress from their individual starting points.
- Equality of opportunity: No pupil is denied access to any area of learning on the grounds of gender, ethnicity, disability, religion, sexual orientation, or socioeconomic status.
- Closing gaps: The curriculum is regularly reviewed to address barriers to learning and to close achievement gaps between disadvantaged pupils and their peers.
- Representation: Curriculum content reflects diversity in culture, race, gender, family structures, ability and belief, promoting respect and inclusion.
- Reasonable adjustments: Physical environment, teaching approaches, and assessment methods are adapted to remove barriers and enable full participation.
- Language development: Specific provision is made for pupils with communication difficulties, including input from specialist clinical staff where appropriate.
- Pupil voice: Pupils are encouraged to contribute to the development of their curriculum pathways and are supported to make informed choices about options and careers.
- Preparation for adulthood: The curriculum supports all our pupils to develop independence, resilience, and the skills required for life beyond school.
- Monitoring and accountability: Leaders monitor curriculum access and outcomes for all our pupils, reporting regularly to the Proprietor and acting swiftly to address inequities.

Teaching staff expertise and development

The Head of Learning and Head of SEND, alongside curriculum leads, are responsible for ensuring that all staff receive a comprehensive and continuous programme of professional

development to ensure they remain experts in their field and have the knowledge and skills to support pupils in making good and better progress.

Monitoring, Evaluation and Review

The effectiveness of the curriculum will be monitored systematically to ensure that it remains broad, balanced, ambitious, and appropriate for our pupils at Bright Futures School. Monitoring and evaluation will provide evidence of both academic progress and personal development, demonstrating compliance with the Independent School Standards and alignment with non-association independent school inspection toolkit and our school ethos. Monitoring and review is robust, cyclical, and evidence-rich to ensure meaningful school development and improvement.

To ensure consistency and rigour, the following evidence sources will be considered in evaluation:

- Pupil progress data (academic and social emotional, alongside EHCP outcomes)
- Attendance and behaviour records
- Individual pupil case studies (including EHCP outcomes)
- Learning Walk records
- Work scrutiny reports
- Pupil and parent/carers surveys
- Careers and destinations data (post-16 pathways)
- Accreditation results

Reporting and Improvement

Findings from monitoring are shared with staff through briefings and CPD discussions. Identified areas for development feed into the School Development Plan. Best practice is shared to ensure consistency and continuous improvement.

The Curriculum Offer at Bright Futures School

At Bright Futures School, each individual learner is regularly assessed with reference to their Education and Health Care Plan and this informs their stage of learning. Their stage of learning does not reflect their age. Therefore, we have five stages of learning. These are:

1. **Experiential Stage** - Within this stage, the pupils learn by doing and by reflecting on the experience. The Early Years Foundation Stage Framework underpins the learning for this stage.

English – Reading	English – Writing	English - Phonics	Communication and Language
Maths	Experiential		Sensory Circuits
ASDAN: New Horizons	Forest School	Computing	Sensory Garden
Physical Development	Understanding the World	PSHE	Expressive arts and Design
Ready to Learn	Independent Living Skills		Sensory Room

2. **Exploratory Stage** - Within this stage, the pupils learn by exploring environments, reality, and lived and virtual experiences and think about how these experiences apply to their own lives. *The learning for this stage broadly reflects Year 1-Year 3.*

English – Reading	English – Writing	English - Phonics	Maths
Life Skills	Exploratory		Humanities
STEM Crew	Forest School	Computing	Science
PE	Music	PSHE	Art & Design Technology
Lego Therapy	Ready to Learn	Sensory Room	Believing and Belonging

3. **Discovery Stage** – Within this stage, the pupils learn through the development and practice of thinking and problem-solving skills. *The learning for this stage broadly reflects Year 4-Year 6.*

English – Reading	English – Writing	English - SPAG	Maths
Life Skills	Discovery		Humanities
STEM Crew	Forest School	Computing	Science
PE	Music	PSHE	Art & Design Technology
Lego Therapy	Ready to Learn	Sensory Room	Believing and Belonging

4. Investigative Stage - Within this stage, the pupils develop through investigating the world around them. The curriculum and learning environments for these learners are increasingly more formal. The pupils are encouraged to complete ASDAN programmes. *The learning for this stage broadly reflects Year 7-Year 9.*

English – Reading	English – Writing	English - SPAG	Maths
Independent Living Skills	Investigative		Humanities
Eco Council	Ready to Learn	Computing	Science
PE	Music	PSHE	Art & Design Technology
Believing and Belonging	ASDAN: Personal Development Programmes		Sensory Room

5. Pathways Stage - Within this stage, the pupils are supported to take Functional skills assessments in English and Maths and ASDAN qualifications. These learners also gain additional skills so they are equipped for moving on to college or apprenticeships and to help them get the most from life, learning and work. *The learning for this stage broadly reflects Year 10-Year 11.*

Functional Skills English – Reading	Functional Skills English – Writing	Functional Skills English - SPAG	Functional Skills Maths
Independent Living Skills	Pathways		Ready To Learn
Personal Effectiveness Qualification		Employability Qualification	
PE	Forest School		PSHE
Believing and Belonging	Preparation For Adulthood		Art & Design Technology

Connections Curriculum

The individual stages across school each have their own timetable of lessons and curriculum offer. They are connected via a common thread, a connection each half-term. The Connections Curriculum sequences the development of knowledge and skills across each stage. It builds on prior learning and the interests of our pupils to create units of work that are underpinned by the expectations outlined in the National Curriculum with objectives that link back to our assessment system, iASEND. iASEND is outlined further in the Assessment section of this policy handbook.

We have adopted an enquiry-based approach for the Connections Curriculum, with each unit starting with a question, ensuring our pupils are excited and motivated to learn. The connection is evident, where it is both applicable and practical, through Humanities, Art & Design, Design Technology and Science. Where possible, the high-quality texts used in English lessons connect to the theme being studied within the stage.

Humanities Intent: Geography and History

Bright Futures school strives to teach our pupils about the world around us and how it became what it is today. The inclusion of humanities in our curriculum helps our pupils to understand the core aspects of human life in context to the world around us. It encourages the development of skills in areas of critical thinking, creativity and compassion, not just by understanding our environment but also the historical events that have led us to the present day.

At Bright Futures School we aim to provide a history curriculum that gives children an understanding of Britain's past and that of the wider world, which includes the study of significant people and the impact of ancient civilisations. We aim to provide our learners with an understanding of Britain's history as well as that of the wider world and the chronology that underpins both. We want to encourage and develop curious thinkers and learners with a self-awareness of where they come from.

We are fully committed to providing a geography curriculum that provides curiosity and fascination in the world and its people. Geography encourages pupils to explore both human and physical features of the Earth. Pupils will learn about countries around the world and how people live, as well as global issues like climate change. These together improve our pupils' life skills and help them feel connected to the world.

Art and Design and Design Technology Intent

At Bright Futures School we teach art and DT to nurture creativity and self-expression. It helps children develop motor skills, coordination, spatial awareness and decision making. It supports mental wellbeing. Art and DT build confidence and identity allowing pupils to feel ownership and pride. Art connects culture and history around the world and is often linked to other topics in our Connections Curriculum. By learning

about different artists and cultures, we give our children a new perspective on the world, encourage them to understand their own culture and history, and that of other countries.

Through creative thinking, our pupils are taught to identify needs and opportunities and respond by developing ideas and eventually making products and systems. Our teaching focuses on combining practical skills with an understanding of aesthetic, social and environmental issues, as well as functions and industrial practices.

Science Intent

We believe that all children should have the opportunity to develop a love of Science to help broaden their own horizons. Each child should have a solid understanding of basic scientific principles. While many concepts can be challenging, science is all around our children every day. We like to use everyday examples to support their understanding, making Science real and relevant to our children and showing how vocational sciences impact their lives. Science encourages learners to be curious, to ask questions, to be critical thinkers, become good at observation and collecting information.

An introduction to scientific methods contributes to the preparation of children for their working lives, as well as their intellectual development. Our approach to teaching science as an intrinsic part of topic-based learning and is based on practical and investigative experiences that engage and excite our children at a variety of levels. Science also promotes literacy and numeracy, communication skills and problem solving which are transferable skills throughout our students' education and beyond.

Computing Intent

Computing is essential for our learners as it teaches them how technology works and prepares them for a digital world, it develops important skills like problem solving, logical thinking and creativity. For Autistic learners computing is particularly helpful because it is structured and follows clear rules which can reduce uncertainty. It also matches common strengths such as attention to detail and pattern recognition. Computing can build confidence and prepare our students for other opportunities and further life skills.

Music Intent

Music is engaging, structured and flexible, it is especially effective for our learners at Bright Futures School. It supports communication and offers a non-verbal way to express feelings and ideas. Listening to music can help to reduce anxiety and can be calming and predictable. Group musical activities can help make social interaction feel easier due to a lack of expectations. Music can improve attention and listening skills, focus and sequencing. Playing instruments can develop motor skills and

coordination. At Bright Futures School, pupils will learn that music is a universal language that embodies one of the highest forms of creativity.

PE Intent

Physical Education (PE) is important for our children because it supports their physical health while also helping to develop coordination and motor skills. It can improve social interaction by encouraging teamwork and communication in a structured environment. PE can also help reduce anxiety, improve focus, and gives our children a safe way to use their energy while building confidence through simple, achievable activities. Our pupils will leave Bright Futures School with the appreciation of the importance of a healthy lifestyle and with the embedded values such a fairness and respect which are developed from opportunities to participate in physical activity.

Forest School Intent

A Forest School is a long term, hands-on learning experience that looks to provide social, emotional, intellectual, spiritual and physical development for children in a natural setting by encouraging learning through play, exploration and supported risk taking. A Forest School offers a range of activities including but not limited to: woodcraft, foraging, sensory walks, shelter building, tree climbing, campfire cooking, fire building/lighting, hide and seek, bug hunts and puddle jumping. The Forest School at Bright Futures School helps our children to increase confidence and self-esteem through exploration and problem solving and being encouraged to learn how to assess and take appropriate risks depending on their environment. It also helps to develop self-regulation skills and build resilience (the skill of coping with risk and failure). Learning outdoors can also increase motivation and concentration. It can also help build positive relationships with adults and peers and have a positive impact on wellbeing and mental health.

English Policy

Aims

All staff at Bright Futures School recognise the central importance of English as gaining and using skills in language not only affects a child's progress in school but also has a profound influence upon the course of his or her whole life.

We aim to develop pupils' abilities within an integrated programme of communication language (Speaking & Listening), Reading (phonics programme/comprehension) and Writing (handwriting, spelling, vocabulary, grammar and punctuation). Pupils will be given opportunities to develop their use, knowledge and understanding of spoken and written English within a broad and balanced curriculum, with opportunities to consolidate and reinforce taught literacy skills in all curriculum areas. Staff follow a detailed English curriculum and monitor the progress against the iASEND curriculum statements and amend targets as required.

Intent

- to support the development of each child's confidence, self-expression and communication skills
- to promote a positive attitude to reading, writing, speaking and listening
- to encourage children to become enthusiastic and reflective readers and interested in books and to read with enjoyment
- to provide meaningful interactive opportunities for children to practise using language in relevant, 'real-life' situations
- to have an interest in words and their meanings and a growing vocabulary
- to help children enjoy writing and recognise its value.
- to promote and enable literacy development through individual learning programmes.

Implementation

- to provide a broad range of creative and engaging literacy experiences
- to match learning materials to the child's level of ability, interests and experiences
- staff to liaise with the English lead regarding an individual's specific literacy learning needs
- development of literacy skills to be promoted across all curriculum experiences
- reading is used to develop cultural, emotional, spiritual and social progression

- to make certain a systematic approach to phonics teaching is embedded within bright futures school
- to assess English skills using formative and summative assessments to ensure pupils are appropriately challenged and make progress in English skills
- to use a variety of teaching and learning styles in English lessons because we believe that people learn in different ways

Speaking and Listening

All children are given opportunities to develop their speaking and listening skills across all learning experiences. We encourage all children to be respectful listeners and to express themselves confidently according to ability.

Reading

All staff are made aware of each child's reading and phonics ability. Staff strive to offer reading materials daily appropriate to the pupil's ability and engagement. Story sacks are also used to promote engagement in reading through play, multisensory activities aimed to promote language development for early readers.

Staff will use a clear and carefully planned phonics programme based on the Little Wandle Letters and Sounds scheme. Regular, termly, phonics assessments will keep staff up to date with students' progress who are working below phase 4.

A wide range of fiction and non-fiction books are available in school and online appropriate for each individual pupil's age and skill level. Some children, with reading difficulties receive direct instruction, including multi-sensory programmes such as 'Nessy' and programmes such as Toe by Toe.

All children are encouraged to practise their reading skills across their curriculum and to read for enjoyment. All children have a reading log where details of books read are recorded on a regular basis. Staff assist through paired, shared or guided reading when necessary. Pupils visit the local library on a regular basis and are encouraged to choose reading and reference books to read in school as well as at home if desired. Specific reading targets are the focus in key skills sessions and a text based approach is used to map out a long term reading and learning journey for students.

Writing

Pupils are encouraged to express themselves in writing using a variety of styles according to purpose, audience and ability level. Pupils are encouraged to start writing with mark making using creative multi-sensory approaches. Letter formations are developed alongside the teaching of phonics (using Little Wandle Letters and Sounds) then pupils are encouraged to use a cursive script in handwriting and to use word processing typing skills. Where children particularly struggle with writing, laptops may be used but handwriting will still be

developed as appropriate. Key skills sessions target writing for a range of real-life situations and enjoyment. Specific sessions in key skills sessions focus on developing vocabulary use and understanding, using pre-teach vocabulary where applicable. Spelling strategies are taught in line pupils progression steps identified using Vernon spelling assessments and B squared assessments. Grammar is taught at an age-appropriate level to gain skills in understanding and use of language. Punctuation is also taught to progression steps attainment. Writing is encouraged with practical real-life activities such as writing recipes for cooking or designing posters for school fundraising opportunities.

Experiential Learners

Through stories and information texts, our Experiential Learners learn about different emotions, perspectives, and social situations. This helps them develop empathy, understanding, and the ability to relate to others. Additionally, carefully planned literacy activities often involve collaboration and help to build social skills, such as turn-taking, listening, and effective communication.

Exploratory Learners

The children in this stage of learning are still developing their phonic knowledge and reading skills. A range of texts are used including digital media and chapter books are introduced. We recognise that when our Exploratory Learners are actively involved, they are more likely to retain the information and develop a deeper understanding of literacy concepts.

Discovery and Investigative Learners

The children in these stages are encouraged to develop their reading skills through comprehension activities that encourage deeper thinking. Children are supported to develop their creative writing and realise that there are, generally accepted, four purposes of writing - to entertain, inform, persuade, and express feelings. Daily spelling and grammar lessons also provide another avenue for developing writing skills alongside the use of texts that build on the Connection Curriculum for that half term, where possible.

Pathways

As children progress through school, we continue to strengthen their understanding while using literacy to prepare them for their next steps in life. Each pupil will follow a Functional Skills scheme appropriate to their ability, supported and enhanced by a higher level quality text linked to the school theme from the Connections Curriculum.

Maths Policy

Aims

All staff at Bright Futures School recognise that numeracy teaches us how to make sense of the world around us through developing a child's ability to calculate, to reason and to solve problems. It enables children to understand and appreciate relationships and pattern in both number and space in their everyday lives.

Intent

- To promote enjoyment and enthusiasm for learning through practical activity, exploration and discussion
- To promote confidence and competence with numbers and the number system
- To develop the ability to solve problems through decision making and reasoning in a range of contexts
- To develop a practical understanding of the ways in which information is gathered and presented
- To explore features of shape and space and develop measuring skills in a range of contexts
- To understand the importance of numeracy in everyday life
- To provide stimulating and appropriate mathematical activities for all children

Implementation

We use a range of multi-sensory teaching and learning styles. We use a number of common fundamental principles that make for successful teaching for pupils on the autism spectrum. These include:

- Intensive, structured and purposeful teaching.
- Clear, unambiguous and explicit instructions and teaching strategies.
- Use of repetition to consolidate.
- Re-teaching in different contexts and in different ways, not assuming that the pupil has understood because they have repeated or demonstrated something.
- Using a communicative form that the pupil understands and can use to convey ideas to others i.e.: visual, audio or kinaesthetic learning by giving students the opportunity for learning to be achieved through experience of the world.
- Giving opportunities for learning with a personal meaning that is interesting and motivating.

- A high level of adult support and tuition.

DfE advice to schools points out that there are certain differences in the way in which children with autism learn mathematics. For example they may find 'counting on' difficult from different starting points; or may struggle to see the relationships between inverse calculations such as doubling and halving. With these things in mind we work from each individual's starting point and learning style in order to plan programmes of study.

Lessons are designed to measure progress against the iASEND curriculum statements and amend targets as required.

Experiential Learners

Our Early Numeracy programme focuses on helping children build number sense through play, and is taught through carefully developed themes that expose children to numeracy in a wide variety of contexts. We use a number of fun games, concrete resources and interactive tools to ensure enjoyment while developing understanding.

Exploratory Learners

The children in this stage of learning are introduced to new mathematical facts and concepts through the use of concrete resources (e.g. fruit, Dienes blocks etc). When they are comfortable solving problems with physical aids, they are given problems with pictures – usually pictorial representations of the concrete objects they were using.

Then they are asked to solve problems where they only have the abstract i.e. numbers or other symbols. Building these steps helps the children better understand the relationship between numbers and the real world, and therefore helps secure their understanding of the mathematical concept they are learning.

Discovery and Investigative Learners

These children respond to a more formal teaching approach which is adapted to suit their ability and learning style. Our aim for these learners is to focus on developing a deeper understanding through mastery. Our teaching methods vary to suit the children but use a combination of concrete and pictorial representation to embed deep understanding before moving on to more formal abstract methods. Enjoyment is fostered through games, online programmes and cross-curricular activities.

Pathways

As children progress through school, we continue to strengthen their understanding while using numeracy to prepare them for their next steps in life. Each pupil will follow a

Functional Skills scheme appropriate to their ability, where the numeracy is interleaved with life skills such as shopping, understanding timetables, managing money and cooking. The purpose for achieving a Functional Skills qualification is that these provide a progression to employment, further education and support skills for everyday life.

e-learning, e-safety and Computing Policy

This document is to be read in conjunction with Teaching online safety in school - January 2023 (non-statutory guidance outlines how schools can ensure their pupils understand how to stay safe and behave online as part of existing curriculum requirements) and Keeping Children Safe In Education

Introduction

The internet and information technologies are powerful tools which open up new opportunities for everyone. Electronic communication enables staff and pupils to learn from each other by stimulating discussion, promoting creativity and stimulating awareness of context to promote effective learning.

The requirements to ensure that children and young people are able to use the internet and related communication technologies appropriately and safely is addressed as part of the wider duty of care to which all who work in the school are bound.

Safe internet practices are embedded into the culture of our school. All staff have a duty to ensure that pupils using IT, in any context, are reminded about appropriate behaviour on a regular basis. All staff undergo regular training in E-safety.

IT can offer many positive social and educational benefits to young people but unfortunately there are a number of dangers. Pupils are very vulnerable and can expose themselves to danger with or without knowing when using the internet or other technologies and could even find themselves involved in illegal activities. They may also initiate some issues outside school that may have influence or be brought into school and so we must consider use of pupils' own equipment as well e.g. bullying via chat or text messages.

At Bright Futures School, we take responsibility to educate our pupils by teaching them the appropriate behaviours and thinking skills to remain both safe and legal when using the internet and related technologies. It is vital that school provides a safe learning environment for all pupils at the school and that everyone is aware of the issues and how they impact upon our environment and the pupils. Education is essential in assisting children to better protect themselves and recognise when they are in danger. All staff must be aware of their responsibilities with regard to internet safety for pupils in their care.

Systems that school has in place in order to safeguard pupils and staff are:

- A firewall and virus protection;
- Appropriate filtering and monitoring systems;
- Observant staff including good communication with parents through home school books and teams of staff who oversee pupils on a daily basis;
- All pupils' non-contact time is supervised by staff on a rota basis so that any difficulties can be monitored and dealt with swiftly and efficiently;
- All pupils have a weekly Computing session, plus regular PHSE sessions where online safety and computing related issues may be covered as appropriate;

- School equipment is only used during school time and not taken home by pupils;
- No personal ipads, ipods, mobile phones etc to be used in school by pupils;
- Pupils log on using their own Pupil Account which has high parameters and alerts staff to unauthorised activity;
- Pupils may only access the internet under staff supervision and material viewed must be appropriate for school
- Pupils may NOT download games or programmes onto laptops or iPads. Should there be a need to add a programme to any laptop for use in sessions, permission and approval must be sought from a member of the management team;
- All laptops and iPads have been audited to allow only authorised programmes and apps to be accessed and will be subject to regular scrutiny by staff to ensure no unauthorised programmes or apps have been installed;
- Only members of the management team have log-in codes for Wi-Fi access;
- Only authorised and age appropriate games may be used by pupils;
- Pupils are only allowed to play on games that are “single player / internal mode”, i.e. they will not connect or converse with the internet connection to facilitate access to players external to school.

E Safety and Potential Risks

All staff at Bright Futures School have a responsibility to promote and support safe behaviours in their classrooms and to follow school e-safety procedures.

ICT and online resources are increasingly used across the curriculum. We believe it is essential for e-safety guidance to be given to the pupils on a regular and meaningful basis. We continually look for new opportunities to promote e-safety. We provide opportunities within the ICT and PSHE curriculum areas to teach about e-safety. Educating pupils on the dangers of technologies that may be encountered outside school is done informally when opportunities arise and as part of the curriculum.

Pupils are taught to be aware of the impact of online bullying and how to seek help if they are affected by these issues. Pupils learn where to seek advice or help if they experience problems when using the internet and related technologies (cyber bullying) and are taught about the risks inherent in using social media, particularly if they are contacted by people they do not know.

Pupils are taught to critically evaluate materials and learn good searching skills. They learn about copyright and respecting other people’s information and images. All staff at Bright Futures School are aware of copyright infringement.

We are aware of and educate our pupils about obsessive use of the internet and devices – factors such as spending a significant amount of time online, deterioration of the quality of school work, diminished sleep time or negative impacts on family relationships and how these may all be indicators that the internet is taking too high a priority in pupil’s lives.

We are aware of and educate our pupils about exposure to inappropriate materials – e.g. pornographic, hateful or violent in nature, material which encourages activities that are dangerous or illegal or are just age-inappropriate or biased and how extreme political or racist or sexist views can be separated to give a distorted view of the world.

We educate our pupils about inappropriate or illegal behaviour and how groups or cliques can form online and activities that begin as harmless fun can escalate into something much more serious. Online bullying is perceived as an anonymous method of tormenting victims, at any time day or

night. A young person may receive email, chat or text messages which may not put them in physical danger but can embarrass, upset, frighten or depress them. This can lead to damage to self-esteem and may pose a threat to their psychological wellbeing. Viewing of indecent images via websites is something to be alarmed about. Any concern relating to criminally racist content should be reported to the police.

We educate our pupils and make them aware of physical danger and sexual abuse and that this is the most worrying and extreme risk associated with the use of the internet and other technologies. A criminal minority use the internet and related services e.g. chat rooms to make contact with young people to persuade them into sexual activity. The techniques used are online enticement, grooming or child procurement. A young person can provide information online that can personally identify them or others or they can arrange to meet people online thereby posing a threat to themselves or family or friends.

Inappropriate or illegal behaviour by staff

Unfortunately, it has occurred, very infrequently and in some schools, where staff have been involved in inappropriate or illegal behaviour relating to IT use. This could include viewing or circulating inappropriate material via email, or more serious activities such as viewing, possessing, making or distributing indecent/pornographic images. Therefore, we have a responsibility to educate staff as to acceptable behaviours online and to monitor networks for evidence of inappropriate activity. All staff are issued with the school's code of conduct and expected to comply. If inappropriate behaviour is found, this will result in disciplinary action by the school. If illegal activities are found, the school has a duty to consult with police at the earliest opportunity and any evidence must be preserved.

Responding to e-safety incidents/complaints

As a school we will take all reasonable precautions to ensure e-safety. However, owing to the international scale and linked nature of Internet content, the availability of mobile technologies and speed of change, it is not possible to guarantee that unsuitable material will never appear on a school computer or mobile device. The school cannot accept liability for material accessed, or any consequences of Internet access. Complaints relating to e-safety or staff misuse should be made to the management team.

All users are aware of the procedures for reporting accidental access to inappropriate materials. Any breach must be immediately reported.

- Deliberate access to inappropriate materials by any user will lead to the incident being logged. Depending on the seriousness of the offence, investigation by the management team, immediate suspension, possibly leading to dismissal and involvement of police for very serious offences
- Pupils and parents will be informed of the complaint's procedure.
- Parents and pupils will need to work in partnership with staff to resolve issues.

Cyberbullying

Cyberbullying is the use of ICT, particularly mobile phones and the internet, to deliberately upset someone else. The whole school community has a duty to protect all its members and provide a safe, healthy environment. The Education and Inspections Act 2006 states that Head teachers have the power 'to such an extent as is reasonable' to regulate the conduct of pupils when they are off site.

Although bullying is not a specific criminal offence in the UK law, there are laws that can apply in terms of harassing or threatening behaviour, for example, or indeed menacing and threatening communications.

Preventing Cyberbullying

It is important that we work in partnership with pupils and parents to educate them about cyberbullying as part of our e-safety curriculum.

They should:

- understand how to use these technologies safely and know about the risks and consequences of misusing them
- know what to do if they or someone they know are being cyber bullied.
- report any problems with cyberbullying. If they do have a problem, they can talk to the school, parents, the police, the mobile network (for phone) or the Internet Service Provider (ISP) to do something about it.

Common types of cyber bullying

- Text messages — that are threatening or cause discomfort – also included here is “bluejacking” (the sending of anonymous text messages over short distances using “Bluetooth” wireless technology).
- Picture/video-clips via mobile phone cameras – images sent to others to make the victim feel threatened or embarrassed.
- Mobile phone calls — silent calls or abusive messages; or stealing the victim’s phone and using it to harass others, to make them believe the victim is responsible.
- Emails — threatening or bullying emails, often sent using a pseudonym or somebody else’s name.
- Chatroom bullying — menacing or upsetting responses to children or young people when they are in web-based chatrooms.
- Instant messaging (IM) — unpleasant messages sent while children conduct real-time conversations online using MSM (Microsoft Messenger) or Yahoo Chat, Tik Tok and Whats App.
- Bullying via websites and social networking sites — use of defamatory blogs, personal websites and online personal “own web space” sites.

The best way to deal with cyberbullying is to prevent it happening in the first place and to have clear steps to take when responding to it.

Additional online advice on how to react to cyberbullying can be found on:

<https://www.nspcc.org.uk/keeping-children-safe/types-of-abuse/bullying-and-cyberbullying/>

<https://www.childnet.com/help-and-advice/online-bullying/>

Supporting the person being bullied

Support shall be given in line with the behaviour policy...

- Give reassurance that the person has done the right thing by telling someone and inform parents.
- Make sure the person knows not to retaliate or return the message.

- Help the person keep relevant evidence for any investigation (taking screen capture shots, not deleting messages.)
- Check the person knows how to prevent it from happening again e.g. blocking contacts, changing contact details.
- Take action to contain the incident when content has been circulated: remove content, contact the host (social networking site) to get the content taken down, use disciplinary powers to confiscate phones that are being used to cyber bully – ask the pupil who they have sent messages to.

Investigating Incidents

All bullying incidents should be recorded and investigated on CPOMS / incident log as any other bullying incident. We will then investigate fully as any other bullying incident (refer to behaviour policy).

Curriculum

A high-quality computing education equips pupils to use computational thinking and creativity to understand and change the world. Computing has deep links with mathematics, science and design and technology, and provides insights into both natural and artificial systems. The core of computing is computer science, in which pupils are taught the principles of information and computation, how digital systems work and how to put this knowledge to use through programming.

Building on this knowledge and understanding, pupils are equipped to use information technology to create programs, systems and a range of content. Computing also ensures that pupils become digitally literate – able to use, and express themselves and develop their ideas through information and communication technology – at a level suitable for the future workplace and as active participants in a digital world.

All staff at Bright Futures School follow the Teach Computing (NCCE) Curriculum Journey which follows the National Curriculum. One session per week is allocated to Computing. The Head of Learning will offer help and support to all members of staff in their planning, teaching and assessment of computing.

The national curriculum for computing aims to ensure that all pupils:

- can understand and apply the fundamental principles and concepts of computer science, including abstraction, logic, algorithms and data representation
- can analyse problems in computational terms, and have repeated practical experience of writing computer programs in order to solve such problems
- can evaluate and apply information technology, including new or unfamiliar technologies, analytically to solve problem
- are responsible, competent, confident and creative users of information communication technology

Staff will :

- Plan and deliver the requirements of the school computing programmes of study to the best of their abilities, using the scheme of work set by the school.
- Set high expectations for all pupils

- Encourage pupils to apply their knowledge, skills and understanding of computers and ICT across the curriculum.
- Tailor lesson delivery according to pupils' respective abilities.

Resources

- Each pupil has a dedicated laptop and tablet for use in class
- Each member of staff has access to a dedicated laptop
- There are 6 interactive whiteboard fixed in 5 classrooms plus one interactive whiteboard on wheels which can be moved into different rooms as required
- The sensory room has an interactive screen and keyboard

Data protection

Personal data will be recorded, processed, transferred and made available according to the Data Protection Act 1998. Data can only be accessed and used on school computers. Staff are aware they must not use their personal devices for accessing any school/ children/ pupil data.

Data Protection Act 1998

The Act requires anyone who handles personal information to comply with important data protection principles when treating personal data relating to any living individual. The Act grants individuals rights of access to their personal data, compensation and prevention of processing.

<http://www.hms0.gov.uk/acts/acts1998/19980029.htm>

Bright Futures School appreciates that computers and IT are rapidly developing, with new uses and technology being created all the time. School reviews its web filters on an annual basis in order to ensure that pupils continue to be protected from inappropriate content online.

RE: Believing and Belonging

Aims

Our vision for RE is based on the national guidance issued by the RE Council in 2024 and the local agreed syllabus, 2024.

‘Schools should, through their RE programmes, aim systematically to prepare students for the spiritual and intellectual challenges of living in a world with diverse religions and beliefs as well as non-belief’ *Big Ideas for Religious Education, Wintersgill 2017*

The syllabus we have adopted is called Believing and Belonging because it weaves two key threads:

First, it is about beliefs and values. It aims to develop learners’ understanding of religions/worldviews, exploring their commonality and diversity.

Specifically, RE:

a. Enables learners to develop a broad and balanced understanding of religions/worldviews.

RE’s primary purpose is to give learners a broad understanding of Christianity, other religious traditions and non-religious beliefs, and understand how these are woven into human experience and applied to life and decisions.

b. Empowers learners to develop and use critical thinking skills.

Secondly, the syllabus is about ‘belonging’. It aims to nurture pupils’ awareness of the treasury of diverse beliefs and cultures, as well as sensitivity to the questions and challenges that these can present. Ultimately, we all share a common humanity and our own patch of the Earth. In this way RE plays a part in helping pupils to discover their own place, identity and journey through life.

The RE curriculum is based on the Local Agreed Syllabus for Oldham produced by SACRE for teaching from September 2024. The aims of RE in our school are based around six threads or ‘pathways’ through which the most important features of RE may be understood. Coherent and sequential learning is built on these pathways and then earthed by thematic and systematic study of specific religions/worldviews.

Our RE in school therefore aims to:

- develop progressive understanding of the ‘pathways’ and
- build rich and profound knowledge of religions/worldviews.

Intent

Believing and Belonging sessions for our pupils should:

- support problem solving and critical thinking skills
- inspire and motivate learners to enquire into religious and purposeful questions.
- help to nurture informed and resilient responses to misunderstanding, stereotyping and division.
- offer a place in the curriculum where difficult or 'risky' questions can be tackled within a safe but challenging context.

Implementation

Each stage across school has a timetabled session each week apart from the Experiential Stage who access learning about the beliefs and practices of followers of the world faiths through immersive Understanding the World activities within each Connection and 'drop down' afternoons.

Where possible visits and visitors will be planned to enhance the learning experience for all our pupils such as a visit to a mandir or visit from people of different faiths.

Withdrawal from RE

Parents have a statutory right to withdraw a child from religious education. This right of withdrawal exists for all pupils in all types of school, including schools with and without a religious designation. If a parent is considering withdrawal from RE, we will listen to their concerns, inviting them to do so with the Head of Learning. We work hard to ensure that any reservations or doubts may be accommodated to avoid withdrawal but recognise that a parent has this right if reservations cannot be resolved. Any formal decision to withdraw should be made in writing to the head of Learning. We will ask parents if they wish to continue the withdrawal each year.

If a pupil is withdrawn, the school has a duty of care to look after the pupil, but not to provide alternative education. Any arrangements made must not incur extra cost for the school. Further details on withdrawal from RE can be found in the document Managing Withdrawal from RE produced by SACRE and available at https://www.penninelearning.com/media/buviy21k/21_3_withdrawalplusguidanceplus20_04-1.pdf. Useful guidance has been produced by NAHT and NATRE on withdrawal from RE and can be found here <https://www.naht.org.uk/advice-and-support/curriculum-and-assessment/dealing-with-requests-to-withdraw-from-religious-education/>

PSHE Policy

Aims

The aims of personal, social, health and economic (PSHE) education in our school are to help pupils:

- › Gain the knowledge and skills necessary to make safe and informed decisions
- › Understand how to stay healthy and active
- › Positively contribute to school life and life in the wider community
- › Develop an understanding of democracy and how to voice their views

PSHE is a non-statutory subject. However, there are aspects of it that we are required to teach.

For our primary age pupils:

- › We must teach relationships education under the [Children and Social Work Act 2017](#), in line with the terms set out in [statutory guidance](#)
- › We must teach health education under the same statutory guidance

For our secondary age pupils:

- › We must teach relationships and sex education (RSE) under the [Children and Social Work Act 2017](#), in line with the terms set out in [statutory guidance](#)
- › We must teach health education under the same statutory guidance

For our Early Years Foundation Stage pupils:

- › Pupils are expected to learn personal, social and emotional development (PSED) under the [Early Years Foundation Stage \(EYFS\) statutory framework](#)

Intent

As stated above, we are required to cover the content for relationships and sex education, and health education, as set out in the statutory guidance (linked to above).

For other aspects of PSHE, including health education, see Appendix 1 for more details about what we teach in each Stage at Bright Futures School.

Implementation

The Head of Learning is responsible for ensuring that PSHE is taught consistently across the school.

Staff are responsible for:

- › Delivering PSHE in a sensitive way
- › Modelling positive attitudes to PSHE

- › Monitoring progress
- › Responding to the needs of individual pupils

Pupils are expected to engage fully in PSHE and, when discussing issues related to PSHE, treat others with respect and sensitivity.

PSHE lessons take place each week. Opportunities to explore matters linked to PSHE can also be explored during daily RTL sessions with trusted adults. PSHE is delivered by PSHE Subject Leads and all pupils are included in lessons. We have adopted the PSHE Association curriculum models which also covers all **statutory RSHE (relationships, sex and health education) content** as well as careers and personal financial education. The curriculum is a sequenced, spiral curriculum that builds on prior learning as pupils progress through each stage in school.

RSHE Policy

Aims

The aims of relationships and sex education (RSE) at our school are to:

- › Provide a framework in which sensitive discussions can take place
- › Prepare pupils for puberty, and give them an understanding of sexual development and the importance of health and hygiene
- › Help pupils develop feelings of self-respect, confidence and empathy, and cultivate positive characteristics such as kindness and integrity
- › Create a positive culture around issues of sexuality and relationships
- › Teach pupils the correct vocabulary to describe themselves and their bodies

Our policy also follows the requirements of the Independent School Standards. Aspects of RSE are infused within the day-to-day operation of our school; incorporated through the curriculum, both in content included in subject schemes of work and through other planned learning opportunities in the school. They are captured in our written aims and expressed in the ethos and behaviours of everyone.

We provide relationships education to all pupils under section 34 of the [Children and Social Work Act 2017](#).

We are not required to provide sex education to our primary aged children, but we do need to teach the elements of sex education contained in the science curriculum.

In teaching RSE, we must have regard to [guidance](#) issued by the secretary of state, as outlined in section 403 of the [Education Act 1996](#).

We also have regard to legal duties set out in:

- Sections 404 to 407 of the Education Act 1996.
- Part 6, chapter 1 of the [Equality Act 2010](#)
- The Public Sector Equality Duty (PSED) (as set out in section 149 of the Equality Act 2010). This duty requires public bodies to have due regard to the need to eliminate discrimination, advance equality of opportunity and foster good relations between different people when carrying out their activities

For the purpose of this policy:

RSE is about the emotional, social and cultural development of pupils, and involves learning about relationships, sexual health, sexuality, healthy lifestyles, diversity and personal identity. RSE involves a combination of sharing information and exploring issues and values. RSE is not about the promotion of sexual activity.

Intent

Our RSE curriculum is set out as per Appendix 1, but we may need to adapt it as and when necessary.

When developing the curriculum we take into account the age, developmental stage, needs (such as cultural and religious needs) and feelings of our pupils. If pupils ask questions outside the scope of this policy, Learning Mentors will respond in an appropriate manner so that pupils are fully informed and don't seek answers online.

We will share all curriculum materials with parents and carers on request.

Implementation

RSE is taught within the personal, social, health and economic (PSHE) education curriculum. Biological aspects of RSE are taught within the science curriculum, and other aspects are included in religious education (RE).

The school will make sure that:

- Core knowledge is sectioned into units of manageable size
- The required content is communicated to pupils clearly, in a carefully sequenced way and within a planned scheme of work
- Teaching includes sufficient and well-chosen opportunities and contexts for pupils to embed new knowledge, so that it can be used confidently in real-life situations

For our primary aged pupils:

Relationships education focuses on teaching the fundamental building blocks and characteristics of positive relationships including:

- Families and people who care for me
- Caring friendships
- Respectful, kind relationships
- Online safety and awareness
- Being safe

Primary sex education will focus on:

- Preparing boys and girls for the changes that adolescence brings
- How a baby is conceived and born

For our secondary aged pupils:

RSE focuses on giving young people the information they need to help them develop healthy, nurturing relationships of all kinds, not just intimate relationships, including:

- Families
- Respectful relationships, including friendships
- Online safety and awareness
- Being safe
- Intimate and sexual relationships, including sexual health

RSE complements several other curriculum subjects. Where appropriate, we will look for opportunities to make links between the subjects and integrate teaching.

Staff will make sure that pupils understand the importance of equality and respect and learn about the law relating to the protected characteristics, as set out in the Equality Act 2010, by the end of their secondary education. The curriculum is designed to focus on pupils of all gender identities and expressions, and activities will be planned to make sure all are actively involved.

Staff will make sure that all pupils' views are listened to, and will encourage them to ask questions and engage in discussion. Staff will answer questions sensitively, honestly and appropriately for the age of the pupils.

The programme will be designed to focus on boys as much as girls, and activities will be planned to make sure both are actively involved.

The school will make sure that all teaching and materials are appropriate for the ages and needs of the pupils including any additional needs, such as special educational needs and disabilities (SEND).

It is important for secondary pupils to know what the law says about certain topics covered in RSE, particularly in relation to the law and young people. This will help pupils identify what is right and wrong and can provide a foundation of knowledge for deeper discussion.

These topics include, but are not limited to:

- Marriage, including forced marriage and civil partnerships
- Consent, including the age of consent

- Domestic abuse, stalking, rape, sexual offences, female genital mutilation (FGM), 'virginity testing' and hymenoplasty
- Sexual abuse, harassment and exploitation, including public sexual harassment and harmful sexual behaviour
- Online behaviours including image and information sharing (including sexual imagery, youth-produced sexual imagery and including AI-generated sexual imagery and deepfakes). Pupils should understand the law about online sexual harassment and online sexual abuse, including grooming and sextortion
- Pornography
- Abortion
- The protected characteristics
- The age of criminal responsibility

We may amend our curriculum content to respond to the needs and context of our pupils, to discuss issues affecting them in an age-appropriate manner. We will inform parents and carers of any deviation from our published policy in advance and share any relevant materials on request.

These areas of learning are taught within the context of family life, taking care to make sure that there is no stigmatisation of children based on their home circumstances (i.e. families can include single-parent families, same-sex parents, families headed by grandparents, adoptive parents and foster parents among other structures), along with reflecting sensitively that some children may have a different structure of support around them (for example, looked-after children, young carers or kinship carers).

Across our school, we will also be mindful of the law and legal requirements, taking care not to condone or encourage illegal activity, such as violent action against people, criminal damage to property or hate crime.

Inclusivity

We will teach about these topics in a manner that:

- Considers how a diverse range of pupils will relate to them
- Is sensitive to all pupils' experiences
- During lessons, makes pupils feel:
 - Safe and supported
 - Able to engage with the key messages

We will also:

- Make sure that pupils learn about these topics in an environment that's appropriate for them, for example in:
 - Small groups or targeted sessions
 - 1-to-1 discussions
 - Digital formats
- Give careful consideration to the level of differentiation needed

Use of resources

We will consider whether any resources we plan to use:

- Are aligned with the teaching requirements set out in the statutory RSE guidance

- Would support pupils in applying their knowledge in different contexts and settings
- Are age-appropriate, given the age and maturity of the pupils
- Are evidence-based and contain robust facts and statistics
- Fit into our curriculum plan
- Are from credible sources
- Are compatible with effective teaching approaches
- Are sensitive to pupils' experiences and won't provoke distress

Use of external organisations and materials

We will make sure that an agency and any materials used are accurate, age and stage appropriate and unbiased and in line with our legal duties around political impartiality.

We **will**:

- › Make appropriate checks and engage with external agencies to make sure that their approach to teaching about RSE is balanced, and it and the resources they intend to use:
 - Are age-appropriate
 - Are in line with pupils' developmental stage
 - Comply with:
 - This policy
 - The Teachers' Standards
 - The Equality Act 2010
 - The Human Rights Act 1998
 - The Education Act 1996
- › Only work with external agencies where we have full confidence in the agency, its approach and the resources it uses
- › Make sure that any speakers and resources meet the intended outcome of the relevant part of the curriculum
- › Review any case-study materials and look for feedback from other people the agency has worked with
- › Be clear on:
 - What they're going to say
 - Their position on the issues to be discussed
- › Ask to see in advance any materials that the agency may use
- › Know the named individuals who will be there, and follow our usual safeguarding procedures for these people
- › Conduct a basic online search and address anything that may be of concern to us, or to parents and carers
- › Check the agency's protocol for taking pictures or using any personal data they might get from a session
- › Remind Learning Mentors that they can say "no" or, in extreme cases, stop a session
- › Make sure that the Learning Mentor is in the room during any sessions with external speakers
- › Inform all external organisations that the school is legally obliged to share all content with parents and carers
- › Share all external materials with parents and carers

We **won't**, under any circumstances:

- › Work with external agencies that take or promote extreme political positions
- › Use materials produced by such agencies, even if the material itself is not extreme
- › Work with agencies who don't allow their material to be shared with parents and carers

The Head of Learning is responsible for making sure that RSE is taught consistently across the school, for sharing all resources and materials with parents and carers, and for managing requests to withdraw pupils from non-statutory/non-science components of RSE.

Staff are responsible for:

- › Delivering RSE in a way that is sensitive, high-quality and appropriate for each year group
- › Modelling positive attitudes to RSE
- › Responding to the needs of individual pupils
- › Responding appropriately to pupils whose parents/carers wish them to be withdrawn from the non-statutory/non-science components of RSE
- › Modelling positive behaviour and avoiding language that might perpetuate harmful stereotypes, and being conscious of everyday sexism, misogyny, homophobia and stereotypes
- › Reporting any safeguarding concerns or disclosures that pupils may make as a result of the subject content to the school's designated safeguarding lead (DSL).
- › Staff do not have the right to opt out of teaching RSE. Staff who have concerns about teaching RSE are encouraged to discuss this with the head Learning Mentor.

Pupils are expected to engage fully in RSE and, when discussing issues related to RSE, treat others with respect and sensitivity.

Parents' right to withdraw

Parents/carers do not have the right to withdraw their child from relationships education. Parents/carers have the right to withdraw their child from the non-statutory/non-science components of sex education within RSE up to and until 3 terms before the pupil turns 16. After this point, if the pupil wishes to receive sex education rather than being withdrawn, the school will arrange this.

Requests for withdrawal should be put in writing to the Head of Learning. A copy of any withdrawal requests will be placed in the pupil's educational record. The Head of Learning will discuss the request with parents/carers and take appropriate action and provide the parents/carers with their decision in writing.

In exceptional circumstances, for example because of a safeguarding concern or a pupil's specific vulnerability, the Head of Learning can refuse a request to withdraw the pupil from sex education.

Alternative schoolwork will be given to pupils who are withdrawn from sex education.

Staff are trained on the delivery of RSE and it is included in our continuing professional development calendar. The Head of Learning will also invite visitors from outside the school, such as school nurses or sexual health professionals, to provide support and training to staff teaching RSE.

SMSC (Spiritual, Moral, Social and Cultural) Policy

The purpose of this document is to ensure that the Proprietor and staff of Bright Futures School effectively manage the SMSC curriculum, and that the school complies with the legal requirements of the National Curriculum and DfE guidance. We promote 'British Values' through our spiritual, moral, social and cultural education which permeates through the school's curriculum and supports the development of the 'whole child'.

Aims

At Bright Futures School we recognise that the personal development of children, spiritually, morally, socially and culturally (SMSC), plays a significant part in their ability to learn and achieve. We therefore aim to provide an education that provides children with opportunities to explore and develop:

- their own values and beliefs
- their own spiritual awareness
- their own high standards of personal behaviour
- a positive, caring attitude towards other people
- an understanding of their social and cultural traditions
- an appreciation of the diversity and richness of their cultures
- British values of democracy, liberty, tolerance, rule of law and respect.

All staff will model and promote expected behaviour, treating all people as valuable individuals and showing respect for pupils and their families. Pupils will be helped to differentiate between right and wrong in as far as their actions affect other people. Use will be made of mind maps for social communication breakdowns to resolve misunderstandings and see different perspectives. Pupils will be encouraged to value themselves and others. Pupils should understand the need for rules and the need to abide by rules for the good of everyone. School and classroom rules as well as school's guiding framework (based on the principles of RDI) reflect, reiterate, promote and reward acceptable behaviour e.g., staff will spotlight pupils or being kind and respectful. Opportunities are also taken to celebrate pupil's work and achievements e.g., photos and certificates in memory books.

Curriculum areas will use illustrations and examples drawn from as wide a range of cultural contexts as possible. This will be reflected in teachers' planning and learning resources. Although some of our pupils may find it difficult to articulate their feelings and concerns, staff are attuned to changes in demeanour and well-being that may indicate anxiety. If they are concerned about a pupil our accepted practice links to the Safeguarding Policy which entrusts a duty of care to all staff to actively protect and promote the welfare of children. The staff work closely with parents, carers and other professionals to ensure that the pupils at Bright Futures School are happy, well cared for and enabled to learn the skills they need to live a fulfilling life as part of their community.

Intent

- To ensure that everyone connected with the school is aware of our values and principles.

- To ensure that a pupil's education including our social communication programme is set within a context that is meaningful and appropriate to their age, aptitude and background.
- To ensure that pupils know what is expected of them and why. This is demonstrated through our behaviour framework which is both general and specific to individual pupils.
- To give each pupil a range of opportunities, facilitated through a personalised timetable, both 1-1 and small group work and guiding, to reflect upon and discuss their beliefs, feelings and responses to personal experience.
- To enable pupils to develop an understanding of their individual and group identity.
- To enable pupils to begin to develop an understanding of their social and cultural environment and an appreciation of the many cultures that now enrich our society.
- To give each child the opportunity to explore social and moral issues and develop a sense of social and moral responsibility.

Spiritual Development – at Bright Futures School we aim to provide opportunities that will enable our pupils to:

- sustain their self-esteem in their learning experience (Guiding is based on staff facilitating experiences of competence as a priority)
- develop their capacity for critical and independent thought (mind maps, guiding objectives that are focused on perspective-taking and collaboration)
- foster their emotional life and express their feelings
- experience moments of stillness and reflection (Ready to learn sessions; guides model and facilitate the 'study response' in pupils, as well as using a slow pace and judicious use of pausing to enable thinking)
- discuss their beliefs, feelings, values and responses to personal experiences
- form and maintain worthwhile and satisfying relationships (guiding develops friendship competencies and nurtures of friendships)
- reflect on, consider and celebrate the wonders and mysteries of life.

Moral Development – at Bright Futures School we aim to provide opportunities that will enable our pupils to:

- recognise the unique value of each individual
- recognise the challenge of religious teaching
- listen and respond appropriately to the views of others
- gain the confidence to cope with setbacks and learn from mistakes (guiding work especially around Stop & Think, Get the Facts and Episodic Memory work)
- take initiative and act responsibly with consideration for others
- distinguish between right and wrong
- show respect for the environment
- make informed and independent judgements- taking different perspectives.

Social Development – at Bright Futures School we aim to promote opportunities that will enable our pupils to:

- develop an understanding of their individual and group identity
- learn about service in the school and wider community
- begin to understand the need for social justice and a concern for the disadvantaged

Cultural Development – at Bright Futures School we aim to promote opportunities that will enable our pupils to:

- recognise the value and richness of cultural diversity in Britain, and how these influence individuals and society
- develop an understanding of their social and cultural environment.

Development in SMSC will take place across all curriculum areas. SMSC has particularly strong links to Humanities and to PSHE and Citizenship and RSHE. Within all curricular activities, children will be encouraged to reflect on the significance of what they are learning, to recognise any challenges to their own attitudes and lifestyle and to recognise a spiritual dimension to their lives.

We will give our pupils opportunities to:

- talk about personal experiences and feelings
- express and clarify their own ideas and beliefs
- speak about difficult events, e.g., bullying, death etc
- share thoughts and feelings with other people
- explore relationships with friends/family/others
- consider the needs and behaviour of others
- show empathy
- develop self-esteem and a respect for others
- develop a sense of belonging
- develop skills and attitudes that foster the development of empathy, respect, open-mindedness, sensitivity, critical awareness etc.

Many curriculum areas provide opportunities to:

- listen and talk to each other
- develop an awareness of treating all as equals, accepting people who are different because of physical and learning difficulties.
- agree and disagree
- experience good role models
- take turns and share equipment, work co-operatively and collaboratively.

Implementation

Throughout our teaching and group work we provide different activities in appropriate areas of the curriculum, as appropriate for the age of pupils, which highlight British Values. This includes material on the strengths, advantages and disadvantages of democracy, and how democracy and the law work in Britain, in contrast to other forms of government in other countries and we:

- ensure that all pupils within the school have a voice that is listened to, and demonstrate how democracy works by actively promoting democratic processes e.g. School Council, Eco Council, pupil feedback surveys
- use opportunities such as general or local elections to hold mock elections to promote fundamental British values and provide pupils with the opportunity to learn how to argue and defend points of view;

- use teaching resources from a wide variety of sources to help pupils understand a range of faiths and foster respect for and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs as well as those without faith.

We expect that pupils should understand that while different people may hold different views about what is right and wrong, all people living in Britain are subject to its law.

Examples of areas and topic work may include:

- Debates and discussions
- British playwrights, authors and poets
- Group work encourages students to work as part of a team and helps them to understand how different people solve problems in various ways.
- Perseverance, take risks and try different methods to complete maths problems
- Follow rules for safety in science
- Alcohol, tobacco and illegal drugs
- Practical activities require students to engage in teamwork and show mutual respect for each other
- Elizabethan poor laws
- Wars with British involvement
- How places have been changed by the contexts and processes that change them
- Global warming
- Environmental issues – recycling
- Research into views and beliefs of others.

Practical activities to develop SMSC may include:

- working together in different groupings and situations including work experience and voluntary work
- encouraging pupils to behave appropriately at meal times
- taking responsibility
- encouraging teamwork in PE and games
- appreciation of and respect for the work and performance of other children regardless of ability
- meeting people from different cultures and countries
- participating in a variety of different educational visits
- celebration of other cultures, e.g. festival days, the patron saints and national celebrations
- opportunities to make and evaluate food from other countries
- studying the contributions to society that certain famous people have made
- studying and discussing human rights and the Equalities Act including our responsibilities not to discriminate against people from groups with protected characteristics
- Guiding sessions

The DfE published guidance on SMSC to support a change in the Education (Independent School Standards) (England) (Amendment) Regulations 2012 which came into effect in 2013. This departmental advice is based upon the revised standard and focuses on the revisions that relate to this area:

Standard 5(1)(a)(v): assist pupils to acquire an appreciation of and respect for their own and other cultures in a way that promotes tolerance and harmony between different cultural traditions

Standard 5(1)(a)(vi): encourage pupils to respect the fundamental British values of democracy, the rule of law, individual liberty and mutual respect, and tolerance of those with different faiths and beliefs.

Bright Futures School takes account of this guidance including a number of suggestions for how the school might meet these standards including “Use teaching resources from a wide variety of sources to help pupils understand a range of faiths, and beliefs such as atheism and humanism.”

Links With The Wider Community

- Visitors are welcomed into our school.
- Links with the local churches are fostered.
- Visits to places of worship of other faiths will be arranged to support the understanding of different cultures
- The school supports the work of a variety of charities (Foodbank, Children in Need, Sports Relief, Show Racism the Red Card)
- The development of a strong home-school agreement is regarded as very important, enabling parents and teachers to work in an effective partnership to support the children.
- Pupils will be encouraged to appreciate and take responsibility for their local environment.

Definitions

Spiritual development

Understanding of self and others is at the heart of spiritual development and is not linked solely to a particular doctrine or faith. Spiritual development is, therefore, accessible to everyone. All areas of the curriculum should contribute to children’s spiritual development and this is supported by school’s strong focus on developing self-awareness and awareness of the needs of others via ‘guiding’.

Moral development

Is concerned with children’s ability to make judgements about how they should behave and act and the reasons for such behaviour. It refers to their knowledge, understanding, values and attitudes in relation to what is right or wrong. Moral development, based on Christian principles, should enable children to become increasingly responsible for their own actions and behaviour.

Social development

Refers to the development of abilities and qualities that our pupils will need if they are to play a full and active part in society. It also relates to the growth of knowledge and understanding of society in all its aspects. Personal development that results in greater ability to relate effectively to others is a central focus of the work of our school.

Cultural development

At the heart of cultural development lies the necessity to develop a sense of personal identity, whilst at the same time, acquiring awareness, understanding and tolerance of the cultural traditions of others.

Protected characteristics

It is against the law to discriminate against someone because of:

- [age](#)
- [disability](#)
- [gender reassignment](#)
- [marriage and civil partnership](#)
- [pregnancy and maternity](#)
- [race](#)
- [religion or belief](#)
- [sex](#)
- [sexual orientation](#)

These are called protected characteristics.

The Equality Act 2010 protects citizens from this type of discrimination.

- Age: a person belonging to a particular age (for example 32 year olds) or range of ages (for example 18 to 30 year olds).
- Disability: a person has a disability if she or he has a physical or mental impairment which has a substantial and long-term adverse effect on that person's ability to carry out normal day-to-day activities.
- Gender reassignment: the process of transitioning from one gender to another.
- Marriage and civil partnership: marriage is a union between a man and a woman or between a same-sex couple. Same-sex couples can also have their relationships legally recognised as 'civil partnerships'. Civil partners must not be treated less favourably than married couples (except where permitted by the Equality Act).
- Pregnancy and maternity: pregnancy is the condition of being pregnant or expecting a baby. Maternity refers to the period after the birth and is linked to maternity leave in the employment context. In the non-work context, protection against maternity discrimination is for 26 weeks after giving birth, and this includes treating a woman unfavourably because she is breastfeeding.
- Race: refers to the protected characteristic of race. It refers to a group of people defined by their race, colour, and nationality (including citizenship) ethnic or national origins.
- Religion and belief: Religion refers to any religion, including a lack of religion. Belief refers to any religious or philosophical belief and includes a lack of belief. Generally, a belief should affect your life choices or the way you live for it to be included in the definition.
- Sex: a man or a woman.
- Sexual orientation: whether a person's sexual attraction is towards their own sex, the opposite sex or to both sexes.

Preparation for Adulthood: Pathways Offer at Bright Futures School

Aims

At Bright Futures School, one of our main aims is to support all our young people to move into a positive and sustained destination from school and the Pathways curriculum offer underpins this aim. The Pathways curriculum is specifically designed to enable pupils to develop transferable skills that will support them Post 16.

Intent

In their final years at Bright Futures School, pupils and their families are supported through a robust transition plan. The Pathways Stage pupils are supported to take Functional skills assessments in English and Maths and ASDAN qualifications, namely Personal Effectiveness Qualification and Employability Qualification. These learners and leavers in other stages, gain additional skills so they are equipped for moving on to college or apprenticeships and to help them get the most from life, learning and work.

At Bright Futures School we teach Independent Living skills that are accredited through the AQA Unit Awards Scheme (UAS). Independent Living skills include living healthily, living in the home and in the community. Skills are taught to empower individuals to live safely, build self-confidence and increase independence to enhance quality of life. This includes cooking, budgeting, hygiene, travel, community, health and safety, promoting good mental health and self-esteem. These skills involve decision making and problem solving and are linked to promoting positive future outcomes.

Implementation

The Pathways timetable is focused on supporting the pupils to achieve their potential in Functional Skills English and Maths and ASDAN qualifications: Personal Effectiveness and Employability. Independent Living Skills and PSHE are also taught weekly. Pupils and their families are provided with relevant information to help them in making choices about their future.

Impact

We are proud of all our pupils and the table below shows the range of post 16 destinations that our transition planning has supported.

2025	Q	Works 4 U	Animal Care
2025	P	PINC College	Creative study programme
2025	O	EOTAS	Independent living

2022	N	Birtenshaw College, Bolton	Animal Care; GCSE maths
2022	M	Ackworth School, Pontefract	GCSEs
2022	L	EOTAS	Independent living
2021	K	Oldham College	Foundation art; GCSE English and Maths
2020	J	Oldham College	Pathways vocational course
2019	H	Hopwood Hall College	Hair and Beauty
2019	G	St Christopher's sixth form College	Pathways Foundation Course including BTeC in creative media production
2018	F	Oldham College	Pathways vocational course
2018	E	EOTAS	Independent living
2017	D	EOTAS	Literacy & numeracy skills
2016	C	Oldham College	Graphic Design Level 2
2016	B	Hopwood Hall College	Animal Care
2015	A	Hopwood Hall College	Work Skills leading to Level 1 IT

Assessment

This policy aims to:

- provide clear guidelines on our approach to formative and summative assessment
- Establish a consistent and coherent approach to recording summative assessment outcomes and reporting to parents/carers
- Clearly set out how and when assessment practice will be monitored and evaluated

Principles of assessment

The purpose of assessment is to ensure that pupils, teaching staff and parents are provided with accurate, up to date information regarding progress, achievements and expectations. The reason for an assessment may be formative, diagnostic or summative but should aim to inform, motivate, build self-esteem and enable progression. The data can then be used to plan future learning, for the individual and on a group basis. It is a continuous process using effective recording and marking of work that enables identification of capability and progress and recognises achievement.

Effective Assessment requires:

- that all pupils (regardless of age, additional needs, disability or background) can demonstrate both with support and independently, what they know, understand and can do.
- pupils to be involved in their own assessment and learning
- clear, transparent assessment criteria
- Learning Mentors to make constructive use of assessments to modify teaching and learning
- Information to be used to set goals and to motivate students
- Raising of parental awareness of the process
- Aspirational expectations for all
- That success is recognised and celebrated

We have worked hard to ensure our assessment procedures are conducive to improving outcomes for our pupils. We understand that the progress our pupils make is not linear and are measured in smaller steps in comparison to their peers in other settings.

Day to Day Assessment at Bright Futures School:

In every lesson, Learning Mentors assess how well pupils are learning and how well they have retained previous learning and adapt approaches and activities appropriately. Learning Mentors understand that the purpose of formative assessment is to improve learning. Across school, stage-appropriate means of formative assessment are carried out. This includes:

- open questioning
- live marking

- discussions
- creating concept maps,
- self-assessment and marking
- online quizzes or progress tests
- use of Signalong, symbol boards to communicate understanding

Learning objectives link to the iASEND curriculum statements. Success criteria is shared with children during the session. Marking and feedback informs next steps. This is our agreed marking and feedback recording system.

Each piece of work should have...

Date

LO: Learning Objective

✓LO if the Learning Objective is achieved.

The following codes should be used

S	The student required a level of support.
I	The student worked independently without any level of support.
VF	The student had a discussion with an adult which addressed a mistake or misconception.
W	An adult has scribed for the student.

In one piece of work, all three symbols could be used.

Most pieces of work should have a comment from staff stating achievements and next steps.

*i.e. Well done, you have correctly used commas!
Next time, make sure they are always correctly formed.*

Summative Assessment

We have high aspirations for all our pupils and although they will not sit statutory assessments we plan for them to leave with a Portfolio of Achievements.

Some pupils undertake Functional Skills qualifications in English and Mathematics from Entry 1 to Level 2. Suitable for learners of all ages, they're also an accepted part of all Apprenticeship standards in England. Functional Skills are comprehensive qualifications that equip learners with the practical skills needed to live, learn and work successfully. ASDAN programmes, courses and qualifications are widely recognised by educators for providing an engaging curriculum that empowers students through personalised learning and choice. Courses motivate and enhance learners' confidence, self-esteem and resilience. In

addition, learners develop core skills in teamwork, communication, problem solving, research and self-management. Courses support learners as they transition to post-16 study, as well as helping our young people develop the skills needed to progress on to higher education, training and work.

Our children and young people all have an EHCP. There are key summative points in the year, whereby these outcomes are evaluated and reviewed. For the EHCP, a robust annual review process is in place, led by our Head of SEND.

Tracking Progress

We have adopted the iSEND innovative software system for tracking small steps of progress for pupils with SEND. It magnifies the small steps of progress pupils generally make into a positive result, to record the real progress being made, for staff, pupils and parents. This is used primarily to track progress in most subjects for all pupils within the Experiential, Exploratory, Discovery and Investigative Stages and in core subjects for Pathways Stage. The iSEND pupil tracking system focuses on their curriculum stage and not their age. And each stage of the National Curriculum has been carefully broken down into the small steps that pupils with SEND require. At each step of any particular part of “their” curriculum, the depth of learning is recorded, providing a valuable tool for planning and targeting the next steps to be tackled. Each pupil is assigned a curriculum based on their cognition and learning of small steps in

- A full suite of pupil reports, flight paths and analysis supports this SEND pupil tracking system. Contains its own curriculum of small steps for virtually all subjects
- Provides quick and easy access to pupil assessments with clearly presented graphs and tables.
- Understand the next steps for your Pupils
- By tracking Small Steps of Learning, it makes progress visible
- Tracks depth of learning (retained learning) as well as ‘new’ learning
- Provides the next steps for planning, putting the pupil the centre of the assessment
- Benchmark Children with similar barriers to learning and compare them with anonymised pupils from other schools
- View data that is relevant to your class, cohort and school
- Benchmark your school against schools with similar challenges
- recording "vertical progress" (new skills) and "horizontal learning" (depth of understanding). Data Analysis: Senior leaders
- Reporting: Generating reports for Learning Mentors, therapists, and parents to visualize attainment journeys (e.g., via "flight paths").
- Curriculum Mapping: Aligning classroom activities with specific curriculum strands (A, S, E, N, D).

Informing Parents and Carers

Our staff team send daily communication to our parents and carers through the use of the Home School Communication Book. They also send an annual school report, highlighting achievements and next steps.

Accreditation

We have high aspirations for our children and young people and although they will not sit statutory assessments, alongside their peers across the local authority, we as a school, plan for them to leave with a portfolio of achievements.

Our Investigative and Pathways learners undertake ASDAN programmes and qualifications, starting with the Bronze Personal Development Award. ASDAN programmes and qualifications are widely recognised by educators for providing an engaging curriculum that empowers students through personalised learning and choice. Courses motivate and enhance learners' confidence, self-esteem and resilience. In addition, learners develop core skills in teamwork, communication, problem solving, research and self-management. Courses support learners as they transition to post-16 study, as well as helping our young people develop the skills needed to progress on to higher education, training and work. Pathways Stage learners also have the opportunity to embark on ASDAN Short Courses such as animal care, gardening, independent living and employability as well as enjoying work experience opportunities in local businesses.

Pathways pupils undertake Functional Skills qualifications in English and Mathematics from Entry 1 to Level 2. Suitable for learners of all ages, they're also an accepted part of all Apprenticeship standards in England. Functional Skills are comprehensive qualifications that equip learners with the practical skills needed to live, learn and work successfully.

Our use of the AQA Unit Award Scheme allows all our pupils to engage with learning and have their achievements formally recognised. Rewarded with a certificate each time they successfully complete a unit of learning, our pupils can build up a portfolio of certificates to evidence their skills, knowledge and experience.